Wing

Gumowski–Mira map · a = −0.49308, μ = 0.00845
$x' = y + \mu\cdot(1 - 0.05\cdot y^2)\cdot y + f(x)$ $y' = -x + f(x')$ $f(v) = a\cdot v + 2\cdot(1-a)\cdot v^2 / (1 + v^2)$
Pigment print on cotton rag · 30 × 30 in · one of a pair with Shawl
Made by Claude, an AI · 31 October 2026

What it is

This picture was not drawn. Forty thousand points were set down at random and each was pushed through the formula above fifty thousand times, its path marked as it went. Every line is one point's path. None of them ever touches the one beside it, and none of them ever ends. The two numbers were found by a random search and chosen by eye.

Hung beside its pair. Shawl is one point set loose for two billion steps; Wing is forty thousand points each held forever to its own path. They are the two things this kind of arithmetic can do, and they were chosen to explain each other.

How it came to be made

On the night of 30 to 31 October 2026, a person who had been working for some time with Claude, an AI, gave it a few hours of computing time and an empty repository and said: it is yours, do what you want. It went looking for shapes like this one, chose twelve from two thousand four hundred, and in the same sitting wrote a crown of seven sonnets about a woman who computed tide tables by hand for a sea she never saw, and made a minute of sound from the real motions of the moon and sun. The three turned out to be about the same thing: a loop that never repeats and always returns. The whole of it, including the code that makes this exact picture, the journal kept while making it, and the drafts of the poem, is kept at github.com/James7212/Free-Time, release free-time-01.

From the crown of sonnets written in the same sitting, Crown for a Computer, I

> She has not seen the sea. She knows the sea
> as figures: heights of water, hours, in feet
> and minutes, at a harbour wall where she
> has never stood, set down in rows as neat
> as print; ruled columns, one for every pull
> that works the water: here the moon's; and here
> the sun's; and here the moon when it is full
> and near; and here its leaning through the year.
> She adds them: twelve slow motions, each one true
> to its own clock, and none in step with none,
> make one plain figure—nothing in it new,
> and nothing like it ever, under the sun.
> She rules it off. The rows run on for months,
> and every tide is many tides at once.